

Speaker 1 [00:00:00] So I'm going to record. Okay, So let's see it. Got it. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:00:05] I also want to record on my phone just in case. Zoom has some issues. I just record quotes. Okay. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:00:17] So let's get started. So thank you so much again for participating in this interview. As I mentioned over text, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships. We believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. So I already asked you this, but I just need ask you again for the recording. Is it okay to record the interview and it will only be used for transcription and note taking, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:00:43] Of course, Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:00:44] Okay, awesome. So first, I'll start with some demographic questions. How old are you?

Speaker 1 [00:00:49] You? I am [46-50]. I'm going to be [46-50]. Oh, yeah. [46-50]. Okay. Yeah, at the moment.

Speaker 2 [00:01:04] How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 1 [00:01:07] So, [Year]. I want to say yeah, around. That's when we met around [Month] in [Year]. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:01:15] Nice. And do you have any children?

Speaker 1 [00:01:18] No.

Speaker 2 [00:01:19] Okay. And then who lives in your household?

Speaker 1 [00:01:22] Oh, just the two of us.

Speaker 2 [00:01:23] Okay. And what is your main source of income? And what is your current job?

Speaker 1 [00:01:28] So I'm an [occupation] at a company named [Company Name]. Do I need to. Can I put names in the interview?

Speaker 2 [00:01:34] Yeah, that's fine.

Speaker 1 [00:01:36] Yeah. And so I [occupation] for my company.

Speaker 2 [00:01:40] That's so cool. Oh, my gosh. And how would you like us to address your partner?

Speaker 1 [00:01:47] Well, so we're married, but you can say spouse. Wife. I'm okay with either. Oh, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:01:58] Okay. Awesome. Can you tell me about, like, your love story together?

Speaker 1 [00:02:03] Oh. Okay. Well, let's see. In [Year], there was. Are you familiar with [Name]?

Speaker 2 [00:02:13] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:02:15] So way back when. You know, they have like little categories where you want to go do some activity with someone like music or go to concerts or, you know, just like meetups and things. And so we connected through there. And basically we went to [University Name], met up for coffee, and then the rest is history.

Speaker 2 [00:02:40] Nice. Nice.

Speaker 1 [00:02:41] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:02:43] And how would you compare the quality of your relationship, compare to that of your friends relationships?

Speaker 1 [00:02:50] Well, I think I want to say that we have a good understanding of each other. So you don't have to talk all the time to kind of just look at each other. Okay, we know what you're thinking kind of thing. But I think that we're different enough that we kind of learn from each other and benefit from each other's opinions and, you know, thoughts. So I think that it's we work well together. So if we have any issues or arguments or whatever, we we work it out. You know, because, you know, we know in the long term, it's you know, it's small things, I guess, aren't as important. It's kind of like pick your battles kind of thing if you've heard that. So we yeah, we just we know that we have to work together. And compared to everyone else, I think I want to say that we're more in sync. Maybe we kind of know each other very well inside out. So I think that's the biggest strength I think that we have.

Speaker 2 [00:03:54] That sounds really great. That's awesome. Can I also ask, like, how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 1 [00:04:03] Fashion. Maybe [1-5]. I mean, I. Yeah. Yeah. [1-5]. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:04:12] Okay. And how would you compare the quality of your relationship now compared to that of previous relationships?

Speaker 1 [00:04:17] Oh, no. This is very much me growing and becoming better as a person because of our being married or our partnership, as opposed to just being an individual. Like, say, in the past relationship, you're just an individual, so you're not really growing so much with that person. But this is different where, you know, we're kind of helping each other improve in some aspects and you know, just work as a team. And so you're learning how to be a team player and, you know, not just thinking about your own needs. So I think that's the big thing.

Speaker 2 [00:05:00] Yeah, that makes a lot of sense.

Speaker 1 [00:05:02] Cool.

Speaker 2 [00:05:03] And for you, what makes a relationship high quality or low quality?

Speaker 1 [00:05:08] So high quality is that you make decisions together. Right. So if you think you are, you're always sort of making sure that they agree or what are their thoughts. You know, you want to get their opinion about things and you're not just making like, you know, executive decisions all the time, because if that's what you think is best, because maybe it's not. Right. So I think that would be the highest, the best quality, the highest quality part, the lowest. For a relation relationship, I think is just the opposite of that. I want to say where I'm you're you're just self-centered in a sense, and so you're not considering a lot of other, you know, issues or just considering other things that should be given enough value in your. I'm thinking about it. I want to say. So many things.

Speaker 2 [00:06:17] And you mentioned a lot like for high quality relationships, like you think about the other person. Yes. When you say you really like when, what are some times like you felt in your relationship that like, either you cared for you, the person, or the other person cared for you?

Speaker 1 [00:06:31] Um, so let's see. Well, one of the interesting things is so she's vegetarian, and I'm not so. I mean, I eat anything, but. So when you're trying to organize something, you kind of want to make sure that you're thinking about her needs, her dietary needs. So we go somewhere and you kind of want to check on the menu. So this is like check of the menu and see, oh, is there something for her? So it's automatic that you're already thinking about her needs. So or say she has, so she has like some knee injuries. You know, what activities can we do where she can enjoy the activity and not exacerbate anything or, you know, risk anything? So those are small things, but I think in the long run that that just helps strengthen I think when you're doing things together and with people and, you know, events. So, yeah, I think that's all I can think about at the moment as an example.

Speaker 2 [00:07:38] Yeah, that makes sense. That makes sense. And can you think of a time where you kind of felt like the least cared for, or you felt like maybe you didn't care for your wife as much as you could have?

Speaker 1 [00:07:52] Let's see. Well, you know, it's funny because sometimes. Say, let's see, you're at a family gathering and you are you get into this automatic mode where you're meeting people and you forget to introduce her or that kind of stuff. So, I mean, not that I don't care, but or and you kind of leave her to her own devices for a little bit and you forget to check on her. So, I mean, I won't I guess it looks like I'm not caring. And that would probably fall under your category of like I'm not really caring as much or like, say, I really wanted to go to this restaurant. I know there wasn't anything for her, but, you know, well, here's a salad, you know. But, I mean, those are kinds of things where I'm not being as considerate maybe. And you think about it in hindsight, Oh, gosh, You know, I should have put a little more time or effort in thinking about those those kinds of things. So, yeah, I want to say that, yeah, that's probably the least caring maybe that I might have been might have shown, I guess. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:09:05] I mean, that's like, the least. It's pretty good, honestly.

Speaker 1 [00:09:08] Gosh, I mean. I mean, not like I can be a bad I can be bad and naughty and forget things, But let's see if I think of something. I'll let you know of something where I got into trouble, you know?

Speaker 2 [00:09:24] If this is if this is a least, this is also good to like. It's. It's. It's all good if it is. But I just thought that was really interesting that like, that's like as far as, like, non

caring things go that's pretty that's pretty good, you know? I mean, so I just thought that was interesting.

Speaker 1 [00:09:38] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:09:42] So for you, like, what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:09:49] Talking to each other. So it's not something I used to do a lot of it's just, you know, try to keep things to yourself and and, you know, if you're happy, then that's good. But then you've got another person that you think about, and if that person's not happy, then it'll affect your relationship, right? So you kind of have a strike, a good balance in between where everybody's benefiting from the relationship. So, you know, we get to do new things, for example, together. So think about, you know, what they like and what they dislike and or are willing to try. So, you know, you're just kind of trying to be adventurous in a way and trying to discover new things together. So I think if in a relationship, if you can do those things, then you can continue to grow. Right. It's just the same old thing every day. And you're not learning anything new about that person or with that person. I think that, you know, it'll you'll get bored or it'll start to create issues down the road where we're. Yeah, it's nothing is growing or nothing's developing, you as a person.

Speaker 2 [00:11:04] Yeah. Yeah, that makes sense. And kind of like shifting gears a little bit, we're going to talk a little bit like the conceptualization of love.

Speaker 1 [00:11:13] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:11:14] So for you, what is love? I know it's a pretty broad topic, but it's broad for a reason.

Speaker 1 [00:11:19] So, see, I want to say that love is when you stop just thinking about yourself. So you're there's this object that you can love or person you can love, but should something happen to that person or object it, it'll affect you. Right. So your I think you want to you get into this mode where you want to protect that person. You want to make sure that they're happy in that they're content or cared for, you know, accommodated. So I think love defined is more of that. You're it's it's some empathy where you can step out of your shoes and say, okay, what does this person need and what can I do for this person? And and not even say, how am I going to benefit from it? Right. It's like I don't it's you only care about that person and not what you know, what you'll get out of it. Right. I think it's just purely unconditional, I guess is the word where you care about that person so much that you just want them to be happy. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:12:34] And how important is love in a relationship, do you think?

Speaker 1 [00:12:38] Oh, like, that's that defines it. I think so. If you don't have any of that, then you're. There's nothing to nurture anymore. It's kind of like if you're just existing around each other and you're not thinking about each other, so. So the love part, I think, forces you internally to just automatically think about that person and how you know and how you're developing with that person. So it's not just you at that point. So so love, I think, defines that it's you just care about that person enough to. Yeah, I think yeah, I think the sort of love should be defined. It's not, it's, it's not just loving yourself or like, caring about yourself. It's also projecting onto or including other things.

Speaker 2 [00:13:38] And how do you know that you're, sorry, that your wife loves you?

Speaker 1 [00:13:44] Oh, yeah, she does it lots of different ways. So it's funny because she does things in action more. I like say it a lot, but she doesn't. But it's what she does that you know, that she does. So she's always thinking about, I mean, little things like, you know, things that I would want to eat or she'll prepare something and I. Oh, cool. Or she'll do something to buy something that she thinks, oh, you know, check this out. You know, you'll like this shirt or something. And like, oh, and then you're looking at it and like. And in the end, it grows on you. So it's it's kind of like, you know, she'll, she'll do things that are proof that she's thinking about me, you know, throughout the day, you know, And you just do things that are unexpected in a way. So I don't expect things. So I think that's that's even a greater that's cooler than if you know that she's going to do it right or she's going to. You know, or like, you know, we'll think about a show that we might enjoy together, so surprise each other, those kinds of things. So not that we I mean, she says it's tough for me to surprise her because she always knows what's up with me. But it's harder for it's not the same for her. I sometimes I don't know what she's going to go do, and it's usually like a form of just love for thinking about me. So. Yeah. Little things.

Speaker 2 [00:15:14] It sounds very nice. It sounds very nice.

Speaker 2 [00:15:19] And now we're going to move on to some conflict and conflict resolution. So what would you say are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:15:30] So. So I want to say that. She she can she can get angry in, like, 60 seconds, like. Meaning like if she's upset about something, it'll go, you know, like poof. And sometimes it's tough to she, she needs time to calm down, but just say so. I'm worthy. It's all cool. We're good, you know? But she is. If she's upset about something, then it takes a while. So I think that's the biggest conflict that we might have and that where our personalities are so different in dealing with just being frustrated about something or stressed about something or. Yeah, upset, angry. Not that it lasts very long. It's just that it's one of those times where you need to I need to go somewhere else. Leave her alone and then come back. So I mean, everything will get resolved anyway, which we already know together. You know, is, is, is going to you know, we can count on that, but it's just more of how quickly can something be resolved or calm or go down to a more calm level. Right. So, yeah, I think it's just the personality clashes in in terms of dealing with those kinds of things with challenging moments or, you know, events. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:17:03] Do you and your wife fight?

Speaker 1 [00:17:07] We have arguments. We don't necessarily fight. I think it's just more of a disagreement because, again, we have different opinions about things. But what's interesting is that in the argument, it'll become a debate kind of like, okay, well, you tell me why and I'll tell you why I think this. And then we can better understand why we we may agree to disagree. But at least, yeah, in terms of conflict, you know, we we kind of just know each other's stance on things and maybe, you know, compromise if needed. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:17:51] Yeah. And how would you say like these arguments last?

Speaker 1 [00:17:57] Oh, gosh. Let's see. There are some arguments which if it's, you know, pretty deep kind of crazy subject it might go on for, I want to say maybe a couple of hours where the cool off period is, is is about that. But in the end, it's. Yeah. I don't think we carry anything more over more than that. Or at least we will go the next day and not resolve something. It's kind of like, okay, let's let's talk about it now or in a few hours.

That's, that's reconvene and then, you know, let's yeah, let's resolve it. So, you know it's it's not healthy I think for a couple to keep have something continue to brew or fester, you know and just make things worse.

Speaker 2 [00:18:51] Yeah. And how often would you say these arguments are?

Speaker 1 [00:18:56] Not often at all. You know, because again, we've been together long enough that we can we kind of. Know how to resolve things quickly or we already know in advance, like just knowing that person that, okay, well, I'm going to come in in a different you know, I'm going to approach this differently because I know how you're going to react, etc.. I it's not often at all. I mean, if if anything, we might have a nice, healthy debate about something, I don't know, once a month, depending on what's on the news or what, say what's happening in the family with their friends or, you know, just something, just some new event or or situation. But maybe once a month we'll have a healthy debate about something, but not very often.

Speaker 2 [00:19:49] And then what are your arguments usually about?

Speaker 1 [00:19:54] Oh, the latest one was because we live in [City]. So there's a big homeless issue here. And I have my own very strong opinions about what what I think should be done. And [Partner's Name] has a different opinion. So she's for example, she's a little more I don't wanna say liberal, but it's she's more her answers are more compassionate towards them. I want to say and I am sort of not I don't have any compassion but it's more like. But it's a growing problem. What can we do with it as a community? And if you know, it's if it's going to, you know, how are we. How do you get rid of the problem? I guess. And I know there's no easy answer. Otherwise politicians would have solved it a long time ago, but we would have debates about that and what to do about, you know, the unhoused. So I don't want to say homeless. I think the right word now is unhoused because they choose to live on the streets and, you know, and what it's doing to your community. So I think that's the latest thing we talk about in terms of, yes, social programs and politics and things like that. So. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:21:13] Okay. Yeah. And I know you kind of touch this a little bit, but how do you usually resolve, like, your arguments?

Speaker 1 [00:21:21] Um, so at some point. We I mean, sometimes I would just say, okay, well, that's I'm not going to say you're right. But I would say I understand. So I think it's just more of you come to an understanding of and you understand where that person's coming from and their opinions about things. And then so you just sort of leave it at that because there's not much more to argue or debate or discuss about it. But it's good to continue talking about it maybe down the road just to, you know, because you want to continue to talk to each other. If you have some thoughts or opinions about something you want to share and you don't have to have and, you know, agree to it or but just listen. Right. So I think it's just more of the listening part. So so because of that, you know, conflicts pretty much resolved quickly, because we know that in the long run, you know, it's it's it's small and not very it's not it's not significant enough to to jeopardize a relationship or, you know, cause us to not. It to me to not talk to each other or, you know, or ignore each other, disregard each other in that way. So, yeah, we'll just resolve things just by talking about it and just agreeing to disagree. I suppose if, if, if we are compromised, of course. But understand why and maybe consider. Okay, well, maybe you have a point there, is, you know, that kind of thing.

Speaker 2 [00:22:58] Yeah. Yeah, that makes sense. And you mentioned you've mentioned a lot about communication, like just talking things out with each other.

Speaker 2 [00:23:07] When would you say you had, like, had good communication and, like, what happened then?

Speaker 1 [00:23:13] Oh, like an incident. You're saying like, where we were really talking to each other? Yeah. You know what? I want to say that just recently. So I know that I've been trying to. I've been delaying your interview because we've been out of town. Right. But we were at my cousin's wedding, for example, in [City]. So one of the things that we had to communicate to each other very well is, is spending time with each other enough and not always just doing things with the family. So, you know how like you're there and everyone's flown in from everywhere and there are lots of there's an itinerary, but kind of making time for yourselves as well. So communicating to each other. All right. So we're going to be let's you know, we have to be at a certain place at a certain time, but let's try in a manager day a little bit better so we can go. So do some of the things that she wants to do. That's not my family related stuff. So, you know, she she's a [occupation] also. And so, you know, where can we go with maybe hit the beach here and there and just stroll around. So spend some time together and not just be like. You know, just part of this crazy family reunion thing. So just communicating on. Yeah. On getting from A to B, a certain, you know, driving here, driving there, picking people up if needed. And even spending time with her, her own friend who is actually in town. So just scheduling. So I think communication wise with scheduling is the biggest thing because we're we're pretty busy, but it's just making time for each other I think is is the biggest thing. Right. No, forget each other.

Speaker 2 [00:25:13] And like, concretely, why do you think communication is important in a relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:25:18] Yeah, because one of the things one of the biggest things that she would gripe about early on was, oh, I can't read your mind right now. She can almost because she knows me so well. But, you know, she would say some. If you don't tell me, then it's a 50/50 chance basically that I. I know what you're thinking or I'm completely wrong. Right. So communication is so key. Is it because you can't you can't make a mistake if you're if they tell you something, if they tell you so as opposed to you guessing. Right. That maybe they feel this way or they know about something. Ah, and you know, you don't want to be completely wrong and just, you know, have this like imagine something for so long and oh, if that's actually not the that I had it completely wrong. Right. So I think you just listen communicate. You don't have to agree. You don't have to be right or wrong. It's just continue to talk to each other so you know about, you know, what you're thinking, the other person's thinking and feeling.

Speaker 2 [00:26:29] Yeah. Yeah, that makes a lot of sense. And aside from communication, what are some other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:26:39] So. So activities. So, you know, we always want to, you know, experience life. So we always say, oh, life is short. Yeah. We like to just look around and say, you know, we want to go do something. Do it now, and don't wait too long, cause you never know if you may not you may not even get to do it if you're, you know, if you wait too long. Right. So, so the element of surprise and just experiencing new things together. Right. So planning new things, really. And yeah, just the small things of just thinking about each other and like, you know what? What would make, you know, her happy if just a

small gesture or, you know, Oh, let's go get ice cream. I mean, something as small as that. Right. But yeah, it's just more action as opposed to just saying it because I like to say it a lot, but it's just more showing it. I think so, yeah. So the communication and showing besides the communication. Yeah, just being just showing things and being open to that person and and not being afraid about what they might think is just being completely honest, I want to say.

Speaker 2 [00:27:56] Yeah. Yeah. Shifting gears a little bit, again, would you say that the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 1 [00:28:06] Oh, yeah, because I've grown as a person. So sometimes I look back, I'm like, Oh my God, I wore that, I did that. I or I would say that, you know, and, and, and it's kind of like I think I feel like I'm a little more well balanced. I want to say in, in my attitudes or perceptions of things, cause I'm not just what I think you know, it's correct. Right? So I get to I get to be open to what other people think. And so I learn that in our relationship, not just from her, but in just keeping a lot of harmony, I think in the relationship in myself, even internally, where, you know, if something upset me before later, why did that upset me? Oh, maybe I misunderstood something. Or maybe, you know, I just need to be more informed or educated about a subject as a as an example. So that's I think the biggest benefit I got out of it is that she, she is actually quite informed with, with. You know, when things are going on, like social programs, like community and things that are happening in the world that you think may not impact you, but they will. They kind of do. And you're like, Oh, it's not my problem. It's it's over there on the other side of the, you know, the world. But no, it's it's important for you to to think about those things and have an opinion and be again, just read up about something and not just. Just form an opinion based on some something you read like a post or meme or something. It's like read about it and get your own informed opinion. So that's that. So that's a I think the biggest thing I got out of being with [Partner's Name], I want to say. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:30:02] And I know you're touching on this right now, but, like, did the relationship change you? And, like, in what way?

Speaker 1 [00:30:11] Yeah. Just be a little more. Considerate of other people as well. I mean, my personality. My personality is my personality. But but it's more of the what had I not considered before with my with other relationships with people, you know, friends, family, colleagues. So, yeah, I think that's that's, that's the most strengthening or what I got the. Yeah. But I've developed the most I think if that was your question.

Speaker 2 [00:30:53] And what about your wife? Did she change during the relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:30:57] She says so. And. And actually, just the other day, she. She said that just being with me, she's less angry or less anxious about how. Versus when she was younger or before she met me. Yeah. She had a lot of, I guess, baggage or weight she was carrying around with her, you know. And so I think being with me, it's just you can kind of let go of a few things, I think is what I got out of her comment. You know that you know, where she's a little more you know, I don't want to say relaxed, but she's she's um. She she's a little more easygoing in a sense that it's she doesn't have a whole lot bottled up inside that she has that she feels is just bottled up inside. She can just tell me and release and, you know, I can be like, you know, just to rant and rave about something and like and just listen, you know, and smile. Okay. You know, feel better now. But it's just one of those things. I mean, it's it's not as simple as what I just said, but in a sense, it's just more of your were calming on each other, calming effects, I suppose if something happens around us

and we can rely on each other. And so that's the comfort of, of, of having each other. I guess that's the comforting part is we that we, we work well together and we have a really good dynamic, I think. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:32:33] Yeah, that sounds great. That's awesome. And do you feel safe in the relationship and why do you say so?

Speaker 1 [00:32:41] Oh, yeah, I certainly do, because I can definitely like. Like if I'm not, I don't say frightening, but if I'm, like, uneasy about something or. Or not. Or confused or doubtful, There's a when we talk things out, it's it's sort of like, oh, I can see better or I can understand something better or. And it's just her being there is comforting because I know that life is better. I don't know how to describe it. It's kind of like, ah, every day, day, day to day living, you know, with that person being there, it's you just feel safe. That's the word really, that you just use safe and that nothing bad can happen to you as long as that person's around. You kind of have that feeling, you know, or because as a team, you'll make sure that you know you're okay, that each other is fine. So, yeah, just being reliant, being able to rely on that person, having someone around to rely on. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:33:53] Yeah, that makes sense. Awesome. So next, I want to ask you a couple of questions. I'm going to use, like the Likert scale. Have you ever seen those? Definitely. You probably have seen it. It's like this kind of thing. Hold on.

Speaker 1 [00:34:11] Oh.

Speaker 2 [00:34:12] Yeah. Like, you probably see, like, this. A little bar graph of. All right.

Speaker 1 [00:34:15] All right. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:34:16] Yeah. So I'm going to ask you like, this question, and then you're going to tell me, like, what? What number you think you are on the scale, if that makes sense.

Speaker 1 [00:34:24] Okay, So my partner usually really this is so this is [Partner's Name] then that I need to rate. Oh, okay. Okay. All right. So I want to say maybe a seven for her.

Speaker 2 [00:34:36] Okay. Okay. Why would you not say, like, six or eight?

Speaker 1 [00:34:40] Oh, well, I see that very true on seven, but there are some times where she can't. She won't hear me. You know, like, say it's like, hold on, I'm not done yet. But then she's already got something going on in her head. And I think she'll probably see me saying the same for me. Or she might even put less than that for me. But for her, it's sometimes like, Hold on, hold on. I want to listen to me first. But then she's already going on with her, her thoughts and her her train of thought. So I want to say very true. Because if it's completely true, then I guess there's really nothing left to improve on. But I think it's a very true for her, who she really does usually. Listen to me.

Speaker 2 [00:35:25] Okay. Okay. That's great. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:35:28] Oh.

Speaker 2 [00:35:29] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:35:29] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:35:31] What? Well, my partner usually is responsive to my needs, but what number would you say for that one?

Speaker 1 [00:35:37] I want to say. Maybe that's more closer to the nine. So maybe an eight. I can't say completely true because there's still we're still still room for four learning and growing. But yeah, I think she's she pretty much she likes to say I know you like the back of my hand is what she would say. So I want to say, eight.

Speaker 2 [00:36:00] Okay. Okay, great. Um.

Speaker 1 [00:36:05] Sorry. Um.

Speaker 2 [00:36:07] And how satisfied are you with your relationship? What?

Speaker 1 [00:36:11] Oh, I want to say completely satisfied here, because I think. Yeah, this. I'm in a good place. Great. Great.

Speaker 2 [00:36:21] Um, and how would you rate your satisfaction in your relationship using, like, this scale specifically?

Speaker 1 [00:36:28] Oh, the scale. I guess you want to say ten just to carry the like like that previous slide you had. I think I want to say it's I'm pretty happy here.

Speaker 2 [00:36:40] Awesome. Awesome. And why not nine or eight?

Speaker 1 [00:36:43] Um, let's see if it were nine or it's because I want to say that I can't think of any instances to go why I would make it an eight or a nine. And I think that she is she completely is in sync with what she believes, what she believes my needs are. And you know how together we can achieve, you know, my goals or, you know, my happiness level, I suppose. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:37:12] Okay. Awesome. Awesome. Okay, That was it. Sorry. These ones are based on if you answered lower.

Speaker 1 [00:37:19] Oh, I see. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:37:22] Okay, so we're done with that also for doing that. Um, we are almost done. And so now I'm gonna ask you a few, like, slightly more personal questions. So feel free to say these are too sensitive for you to share. Okay. But we wanted to know more about, like, your physical intimacy as a couple. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 1 [00:37:51] Lately? Not as much because I'm so busy and I've been working late. So by the time you come home with her, she's okay. But lately, not as often as, say a year or two ago. So I don't know. Do you need a number or training or. Or. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:38:15] A number would be helpful. Like, maybe. Like how many times? Like a month or a week, depending.

Speaker 1 [00:38:20] Okay. Um, I want to say if I can do the month only because it's been so busy lately. I want to say, like, maybe a couple of times in a month or so. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:38:33] Okay. Okay. How about your goal, as you're saying, is more a year ago?

Speaker 1 [00:38:38] I want to say so. Maybe like so if I was, say, the month, maybe three or four or maybe double that a little bit, if you know, less busy, less stressful. Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:38:54] And how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 1 [00:38:57] Oh, good. Yeah. Quite satisfied. I think it's it's healthy, you know, having that intimacy when you can. Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:39:06] Awesome. Those were all the personal questions, so.

Speaker 1 [00:39:11] Oh, not too bad.

Speaker 2 [00:39:14] I won't keep saying. I was like, Oh, that was going to be like really, really personal questions.

Speaker 1 [00:39:19] They're not that Personal.

Speaker 2 [00:39:23] Sorry. I'm just looking through the guide. Okay. Those were all the questions I had about your relationship. So I just summarize, like, what we've conversed about so far. Okay. So you're very. You seem very satisfied with your relationship. You talk a lot about how you communicate a lot and how, like, you know, like your partner, like the back of your hand and how you guys, like, know how to care for each other and know each other's needs pretty well. You talk about like communicating as a form of conflict resolution and that you're satisfied with like your sex life as well. So is there anything that I've missed in what I've told you or anything else you'd like to add about your relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:40:10] Well, I think you summarize it pretty well. But now she says she knows me like the back of her head. I can't say the same for her, though.

Speaker 2 [00:40:17] Oh, okay. That's interesting.

Speaker 1 [00:40:19] She is. She's very, very confident in that. She knows me. And I think that she's she's demonstrated that, that she does know me. But I don't know. You've got to keep a little mystery sometimes in your relationship. Get excited. Maybe I'll throw a curveball once in a while. Ha, ha. You thought that's what I was going to say or do, But no, but. But, yeah, you you summarized it. I think it's just keep it fun generally. Right. Try and keep things fun and not too mundane and too boring. I mean, yeah. Day to day stuff, you know, it's. You're living with someone, you know, being with someone day to day, but, you know, throw in some some new things here and there. I think that's what keeps it, keeps it young and fresh. We've been together for a while, but yeah, there's still opportunities to keep things sort of young and fresh, I think..

Speaker 2 [00:41:12] You know, I agree. I always am down for doing things for fun, and I think that's always the best way to go about life is.

Speaker 1 [00:41:21] Hey, I'm looking at all of your pictures of what your mom posed, and you guys are going to all these cool places, and man, you guys have great sunsets and. Yeah, that's great. I love that.

Speaker 2 [00:41:33] Yes. Yes, we do travel a lot. Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:41:38] Yeah. Because actually. So your mom's [Nationality] and your dad's [Nationality]?

Speaker 2 [00:41:42] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:41:42] Yeah. So are you bilingual there?

Speaker 2 [00:41:45] Yeah, I'm trilingual.

Speaker 1 [00:41:47] Oh, yes, of course. Trilingual. So. Wow. That is too cool. That is too cool. Yes. Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:41:54] Yes. Yes. It is.

Speaker 1 [00:41:55] I never do that to meet your sister because she wasn't born then, but. So. Yeah. So I'm like, Oh, look at her [Name]'s this all grown up. But I never got to meet your sister because. Yeah, I've. Since I moved up to the city, I haven't had a chance to spend too much time with your, you know, with my Chinese friends like your mom down in the [City]. So, yeah, I love looking at the pictures of your family and your mom and stuff. Do you.

Speaker 2 [00:42:23] Do you Have family in [City] or why do you try.

Speaker 1 [00:42:25] Cousins? So, yeah, so I'm from [City], and so my mom and my mom and dad and my sister still live back there. So we see each other. We visit. I go over there once in a while. I've got nieces and nephew over there. But yeah, I've got some cousins in [City] that are very close with. So my my mom's sister's kids. So yeah, it's pretty spread out as a as an extended family, I suppose. But we're pretty close. So we get to see each other here and there.

Speaker 2 [00:42:55] That's awesome. That's great. That's great. Did you, my mom, meet here through [sport] or?

Speaker 1 [00:43:01] Yeah. So, yeah, a long time ago, I think we we never played for the same team. We were always playing against each other, so it's always been fun. But yeah, that's just. I've known her for a long time. Yeah, definitely a really super nice person.

Speaker 2 [00:43:19] Yeah, That's what she said about you to.

Speaker 2 [00:43:25] You're probably. You're probably like you interview. I was like, Okay, I hope so.

Speaker 1 [00:43:29] Yeah. She reached out to me. I'm not sure. For little [Name]. Oh, yeah. Oh, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:43:35] Thank you for doing this. Um.

Speaker 1 [00:43:38] Yeah. I think you have something set up with [Partner's Name] sometime. I guess so. Yeah. It's more like, Oh, All right. So we hope that she says good things about me.

Speaker 2 [00:43:49] Yes. Yes. Ask her about, like, what you talked about. We talked about here too, if you want. It's not like, super confidential, but. Oh.

Speaker 1 [00:43:58] Okay. But yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:44:02] Kind maybe the fun of it. But you have to, like, want to like.

Speaker 1 [00:44:05] You know. No, no. Yeah. I don't want to, like, ruin everything for her or whatever, but if she asked me how it went, I'm like, yeah, it was fun. It was, you know, really good questions. I will say

Speaker 2 [00:44:13] Okay, awesome, awesome. So, yeah, thank you so much. Again, I just have like two more things.

Speaker 1 [00:44:19] Just like.

Speaker 2 [00:44:21] Kind of like. Anyways, um, before we and I want to talk to you about how we will handle the data project. We want to be as ethically transparent as possible, and we wanted to know which data sharing option you're most comfortable with. There's two options. And they were also like, talked about In the consent form. So if you want to go with like what? You have your consent form, let me know. But the first option is that the transcript portions can be shared. None of us can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers.

Speaker 1 [00:44:59] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:45:00] If you're bolder, another option is that the whole transcript can be shared and it will be removed of sensitive and overly identifying details. So it will be anonymized. Although in this option there is a minimal chance that someone who knows you well can piece together the details of the transcript and they're asked who among their colleagues or like peers it is okay. Again, no sensitive information will be shared, but it might like so there will be identifiable information if that's something that you're concerned about.

Speaker 1 [00:45:33] I am not concerned. I think whatever you need.

Speaker 2 [00:45:36] Okay, sounds good.

Speaker 1 [00:45:36] Whatever you got for me in any way you need.

Speaker 2 [00:45:39] Okay. Awesome.

Speaker 1 [00:45:43] And then.

Speaker 2 [00:45:45] So I would like you to know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and the U.S.

Speaker 1 [00:45:52] Right. I think I read that somewhere.

Speaker 2 [00:45:54] Yeah, I probably tend to do that because that's kind of.

Speaker 1 [00:45:56] One little thing. You got a big research team, then? Cool. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:46:01] Yeah, it is pretty cool. I'm. I'm having a good time. So for the research study to be successful, there is one thing that we will ask. If that's Okay, could you and this is okay if you can't do this, but could you recommend to close people in your life as a nominator? And basically how this works is we will ask them for additional couples.

Speaker 1 [00:46:24] Oh, you.

Speaker 2 [00:46:25] Might be interested in the study just because like the way that we do research here is that we basically do snowball sampling. So we interview a couple and then ask them for people to nominate and then ask them if they have another couple couples that they know would be interested, if that makes sense.

Speaker 1 [00:46:43] Yes, we have definitely some some LGBTQ I think it's grown the acronym, but one of the friends that I can definitely recommend though, hopefully they will sign up, and if they're too busy, then okay, maybe not. But yeah, we can think of some. I can definitely think of some folks.

Speaker 2 [00:47:04] Okay, that be great. Yeah, if you could either. Yeah, if you could. Does email or text work better for you?

Speaker 1 [00:47:11] Either way, whatever is easiest for you. Email. I checked my email every day anyway, but a text will get definitely get my attention. It gets up to my phone. But yeah, just text me in and I can probably get you some some names. I don't know if I have the emails, but I have their names and say phones, but I can ask permission if you want from them. If you want if you if they're okay being contacted directly I guess if that's a way if that's a process.

Speaker 2 [00:47:42] Yeah. Basically like what we ask is for you to contact them for that and to see if they're okay with it and if they look like them. Or you can tell them that I will contact them either way works. But oh okay. It is better if you contact them first just so that they like know that I'm not like some random person, if that makes sense. So yeah, that would be great. I will send you a text or email your text. I like thinking now either. Okay, I'll probably email you because I also need to send like a little a link for a little survey if you.

Speaker 2 [00:48:23] It takes. Like, it's like it's very quick.

Speaker 1 [00:48:26] Right. Well, thank you for the [App]. Yes. I just like, Oh, yeah, I've been. Everything's been [App] everything now or Hello sign or whatever it was. But that helped a lot because I don't have access to printing something or I can, but it's going to take a while.

Speaker 2 [00:48:41] Oh, yeah, Yeah. No worries. That were.

Speaker 1 [00:48:42] So cool. Thank you. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:48:44] Yeah, of course, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:48:45] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:48:47] It made me learn how to use [App]. That was very helpful.

Speaker 1 [00:48:50] Yeah, no, I signed everything through that. And so I'm sure, like, our friends would probably maybe ask you the same thing because, you know, I don't know what kind of access they have to a printer and scanning and signing. So, you know, it's. You know, online is great. [App] is so easy.

Speaker 2 [00:49:08] Yeah. I completely agree. [App] is so nice. This isn't just digital, you know. You have to sign it. You put your digital signature in then.

Speaker 1 [00:49:17] Exactly. I mean, I know that it's sort of the words kind of ran across the page in the [App], but the fact that you sent a PDF so we could actually read the document that the when me, when I saw [App], I was like, Oh yeah, these are the same words. But then now we get the checkboxes and the sign electronic signature. So let's get some good. Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:49:39] Okay, I'll make sure to continue using [App] for now on. I'm, I'm glad I'm learning this, but yeah, I will use [App] now.

Speaker 1 [00:49:46] Yeah, cool.

Speaker 2 [00:49:49] Sounds good. Okay. That was all I had for you. Do you have any other questions for me or.

Speaker 1 [00:49:53] Oh, no. Okay. Thanks, kid. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:49:57] Is it weird to be interviewed by, like.

Speaker 1 [00:50:00] I don't know. You can read, like, for like. Oh, my God, No. She's in college interviewing me. Like, what is going on?

Speaker 2 [00:50:07] I know. It's crazy.

Speaker 1 [00:50:09] How much more do you have til you graduate?

Speaker 2 [00:50:12] I have [1-5] more years, so I've got time.

Speaker 1 [00:50:14] Right. So, [University Name], right?

Speaker 2 [00:50:17] Yeah. [University Name].

Speaker 1 [00:50:18] Right. Because guess where she's going? Oh, [University Name]. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:50:23] Just living my life up there. The beach every day definitely can be awesome.

Speaker 1 [00:50:30] Well, hey. All right, so, you know, let me know if there's anything else you need, but. Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:50:35] Yeah, yeah. Thank you so much for doing this. And I'll. I think I'll reach out to you by email, so just check on your email and I will. I will email.

Speaker 1 [00:50:43] You. Sounds good.

Speaker 2 [00:50:45] Also.

Speaker 1 [00:50:45] So much. All right. Have a good one.

Speaker 2 You too. Thank you.

Speaker 1 Take care. Bye.